

Without the help of my staff at Vanguard's Bogle Financial Markets Research Center, bringing the simple idea expressed in a short poem to its flowering into a book would have been virtually impossible. So I extend special thanks to Emily Snyder and Sara Hoffman for their efforts—always under the pressure of time—to fight their way through my inscrutable handwriting and to type and edit endlessly. I also salute Kevin P. Laughlin, my staff assistant for the past nine years, for his admirable performance, producing research on demand, checking accuracy, and making constructive editorial suggestions that made this a better book. Best of all, each of these wonderful souls did their work with infinite patience, good cheer, and professional excellence.

Speaking of patience and good cheer, I also thank Eve, my wonderful wife of 52 years, for her caring and loving support through all those years and through good times and times that were not so good, even as she wonders about my commitment to keep on battling, speaking, and writing books. Of course she's right to do so!

J. C. B.